CATEGORISATION LENS MATRIX

Five lenses mapped against the five levels of the National Athlete Categorisation Framework. The weight of each lens shifts as an athlete moves up, so one matrix shows what matters most at each stage and where a stalled athlete is being held back. Every lens is judged against the sport's What It Takes To Win.

THE FIVE LENSES

EACH BUILDS THE NEXT

FOUNDATION
INVESTMENT
Funding, services and expertise directed at the athlete's gaps.

›

BUILDS
ENVIRONMENT
Coaching, support team, daily training and life around sport.

›

PROTECTS
AVAILABILITY
Health and the ability to train and compete consistently.

›

ALLOWS
PROGRESSION
The rate of development towards the WITTW standard.

›

PRODUCES
PERFORMANCE
Results against benchmark and pinnacle events.

A gap early in the chain shows up in results later. A program can post results today while its environment struggles.

THE FIVE LEVELS

NATIONAL ATHLETE CATEGORISATION FRAMEWORK

EMERGING
Talent identified with early markers

DEVELOPING
On the pathway with gaps closing

PODIUM POTENTIAL
Projected to reach podium level

PODIUM READY
Capable of podium at the pinnacle event

PODIUM
Delivering podium results

Categorisation rests on evidence of future podium capability and is reviewed each year.

THE MATRIX

WHAT CARRIES THE MOST WEIGHT AT EACH LEVEL

LENS	EMERGING	DEVELOPING	PODIUM POTENTIAL	PODIUM READY	PODIUM
CORE QUESTION	*Is the capacity there?*	*Is it developing on track?*	*Can it reach podium level?*	*Can it deliver at the pinnacle?*	*Can it be repeated?*
PERFORMANCE	●	●	◉	⬤	⬤
PROGRESSION	⬤	⬤	⬤	◉	●
AVAILABILITY	◉	◉	⬤	⬤	⬤
ENVIRONMENT	⬤	⬤	◉	◉	◉
INVESTMENT	●	◉	⬤	⬤	◉

⬤ PRIMARY ◉ KEY ● SUPPORTING

Progression and environment lead early. Performance and availability lead late. Investment peaks in the middle, where support decides who converts potential into podium capability.

WHAT ON TRACK LOOKS LIKE

EVIDENCE FOR EACH LENS AT EACH LEVEL

LENS	EMERGING	DEVELOPING	PODIUM POTENTIAL	PODIUM READY	PODIUM
Performance	Results at national youth or junior level. Key WITTW markers emerging.	Competitive at open national level. Junior or under 23 international results.	Finals at benchmark events. Within a set margin of podium marks.	Podium or near podium at benchmark events. Meets WITTW at pinnacle standard.	Podium at the pinnacle event or world championship and repeated.
Progression	Improving faster than the pathway curve. Coachable and learning quickly.	On track against the development framework. Gaps closing year on year.	Clear projection to podium within the cycle. IPP gaps shrinking as planned.	Closing the final gaps. Selection secured or on track.	Holding level while refining the last margins.
Availability	Consistent training. Growth and load managed.	Availability above an agreed threshold. Injury history understood.	High availability through heavy blocks and travel.	Fit at every benchmark event. Peaking reliably.	Availability protected across the season and cycle.
Environment	Quality coaching and a stable daily environment. Life balanced.	Access to a performance environment and support services.	Daily environment matches the WITTW. Integrated support team.	Campaign planning, competition simulation and wellbeing in place.	Staff continuity, athlete voice and career planning.
Investment	Pathway and talent funding. Broad, low cost support.	Targeted services against IPP gaps.	Directed at the biggest gaps to podium.	Campaign investment in competition, travel and specialists.	Sustain and protect, with succession planned.

HOW TO USE IT

TWO WAYS

PRIORITISE

Read down a column for the level an athlete or squad sits at. The large dots show where time, attention and money should go first. Use it when planning a season, setting an individual plan or deciding where investment goes across a program.

AUDIT

When an athlete is not moving up, work through the matrix from the level above their current one.

1. Confirm the target level and what it requires against the WITTW.
2. Rate the primary lenses for that level first. These decide movement.
3. For any lens below standard, check the lens before it in the chain.
4. Agree one or two actions with an owner and a review date.

COMMON STALL PATTERNS

THE SYMPTOM AND WHERE TO LOOK

PATTERN	WHAT IT USUALLY MEANS	WHERE TO LOOK
Strong results but no categorisation movement	Results are not tracking towards WITTW markers or the projection to podium is unclear	Progression and the IPP
Progression on paper, results not converting	Availability or competition exposure is limiting delivery	Availability and the competition plan
Repeated injury or illness	Load is outrunning capacity or recovery	Availability and the environment
Talented athlete with a flat trajectory	Coaching, support or life balance is not keeping pace	Environment
Known gaps that are not being fixed	Support is not directed at the gaps that matter	Investment
Podium athlete starting to slip	Staleness, motivation or a field that has moved on	Environment, progression and the latest WITTW